

Staff Days — Week 1, Day 1 (Mon Jul 27)

Joe's Opening Keynote — *Get Better As We Get Bigger*

0:35–1:21

Framing. Fifth Staff Days. Walked through the history — Year 1 rebuild from whiteboards full of problems, Year 2 Brownsville, Year 3 Miami and "kids can do the impossible," Year 4 a dozen new campuses. Point of the exercise: OGs in the room have already lived through whatever problem you'll hit this year, so ask them.

The core claim. Educational systems historically get *worse* as they scale. Alpha's bet is the opposite. "Getting bigger is only useful if we get better. If we ever stop getting better, we need to stop getting bigger."

Half 1 — How we get better as we get bigger

1. **Go through every mistake.** Every student who didn't get the three commitments, every family that didn't re-enroll, every guide hire that didn't work out. Build the whiteboards of problems first. Rationale: it bakes solutions into the system, it's the fastest way to transmit knowledge to new staff, and it's the core of the culture — *it's easy to hide in the averages*.
2. **Painfully insightful metrics.** Metrics designed to hurt, not to confirm. "96% of kids love school" has no data left in it; "do kids love school more than vacation" does. Also cited: "is there anybody in your class who'd ever bully you?" Joe's argument is that only humans generate these — LLMs regress to the average and reject the extremes.
3. **Build systems to track it.** AI-built dashboards on top of those metrics so quality is visible at campuses no one has visited.

Half 2 — Unleash kids' awesomeness (AlphaCore)

Academics are being solved; the big product push this year is the **life skills stack**. Three dimensions of work:

- **Banger alpha tests** for every workshop — so compelling parents feel stupid saying no. (Kindergartners bike 5 miles; second graders run 5Ks; Tough Mudder where the team crosses together.)
- **Vertical stack, K–12**, for each of the five categories: leadership & teamwork; storytelling & public speaking; entrepreneurship & financial literacy; relationship building & socialization; grit & hard work. Scaffolding and progression, so a transfer student's gaps are visible and fixable.

- **Horizontal** — what *is* an Alpha kindergarten, middle school, high school? Parents buy the bundle, not the stack.

Goal for the two weeks: publish AlphaCore at a standard a superintendent or minister of education could adopt. Alex Hormozi is helping build the Founder School curriculum.

Specialty schools as the model for clarity: Founders School (earn \$1M profit in high school or tuition back), Sports Academy (double your odds of a D1 scholarship), GT² (MIT-academically-eligible by middle school, 4 hrs/day in apps instead of 2).

Post-Lunch Tee-Up — *Alpha Canon* → Build Sessions

4:52–5:10

Canon = source of truth. Written clearly enough that a guide hired tomorrow can read the top of the doc and run the thing correctly. Also the material that gets fed to AI so it stops producing vanilla outputs.

The Spain analogy. Spain won the World Cup in 2010 and again in 2026 with an entirely different roster, conceding one goal all tournament — because the system never changed. Players change, tactics don't.

One Alpha. ~56+ campuses, ~250 guides, thousands of kids, all running one system. Drop-off in San Francisco should look like drop-off in Miami.

The three tiers

Every "work unit" — anything touching student or parent experience — gets built in three layers:

Tier	What it is	Rule
1 — Standard	The canon. Non-negotiable, identical everywhere.	If you don't do it this way, don't call yourself an Alpha.
2 — Flavor	Level variance. K1 morning launch ≠ middle school launch, but the spirit and the 15 minutes are the same.	Where your age-band expertise comes in.
3 — Magic	Guide craft. The chants, nicknames, jokes, songs.	Came out of the "what's silently working" exercise —

Tier	What it is	Rule
		guides said protect creativity and autonomy above all.

Example of Tier 1 written properly: the 1:1 Limitless meeting is 25 minutes, weekly, during TimeBack learning, demonstrating mentor mindset.

Build assignment

Breakouts by level group with a head guide in the room. Six of the eventual 25 work units covered today: **Limitless Launch, Limitless Meetings, Get to Know You Lunch, Limitless Lunch, Town Hall, Closings**. Process: read the top of the doc → does it read as canon, is anything unclear or misaligned → then build Tier 2 → then Tier 3.